

00. Understanding printf

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3:38 PM

`echo` basic print
`printf` print formatted data

! don't give user specified data to printf as its first argument

`printf '%.5s\n' "$var"`
↳ format specifier (the first arg will be formatted as a string)

`printf 'my str is (%.5s)\n' "$var"` to see the change printf applies

`printf '%.5s %.5s\n'` can now accept 2 arguments

`printf '%.5s %.5s'` pad the arg up to n with whitespaces

`printf '%.5s'` pad to the right

`printf '%.5s' n arg` pad the arg with n

`printf '%d\n'` for formatting a number

`printf '%c\n'` for formatting a character
mentioned

`printf '%g\n'` format data in a shell-friendly way

`printf '%b'` interpret raw hex codes

`printf -v var '%s\n' str` print the formatted string to the variable